

doc-christ-session-exaltation

Affirms · Christology › Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

The risen Christ is exalted at the right hand of the Father, reigning and interceding for His people.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical chain locks the post-ascension session and exaltation of Christ at the right hand of God, reigning and interceding. Ps 110:1 (yashav H3427 imperative shev, sit; yamin H3225 right hand; ne'um H5002 declaration of YHWH to adoni my Lord) is the most-quoted OT verse in the NT (25+ NT citations or allusions). Mark 16:19 ekathisen (G2523 aorist, sat down) ek dexion (G1188) tou theou. Acts 2:33-36 Peter at Pentecost: hypsōtheis (G5312 aorist passive participle, having been exalted) tē dexia tou theou; v.34-35 quotes Ps 110:1 directly, arguing David did not anabē (G305 ascend) but Jesus did, therefore the Lord-said-to-my-Lord sit-at-my-right-hand applies to the ascended Jesus; v.36 concludes kyrion (G2962) auton kai christon (G5547) epoiēsen ho theos (God made him both Lord and Christ). Acts 7:55-56 Stephen sees Jesus hestōta (G2476 perfect active participle, standing) ek dexion tou theou. Eph 1:20-22 egeiras (G1453) auton ek nekrōn kai kathisas (G2523 aorist participle) en dexia autou en tois epouraniois (G2032), hyperanō (G5231 far above) pasēs archēs (G746 rule) kai exousias (G1849 authority) kai dynamēōs (G1411 power) kai kyriotētos (G2963 dominion) kai pantos onomatos (G3686) onomazomenou, with all things hypetaxen (G5293 subjected) under his feet. Phil 2:9-11 ho theos auton hyperypsōsen (G5251 highly exalted) kai echarisato (G5483) autō to onoma to hyper pan onoma (the name above every name) hina en tō onomati Iēsou pan gony (G1119 knee) kampsē (every knee bow). Col 3:1 hou ho Christos estin en dexia tou theou kathēmenos (G2521 present middle participle, seated). Heb 1:3 ekathisen en dexia tēs megalōsynēs (G3172 Majesty) en hypsēlois (G5308 on high); 1:13 quotes Ps 110:1 directly; 8:1 ekathisen en dexia tou thronou tēs megalōsynēs en tois ouranois; 10:12 eis to diēnekes ekathisen en dexia tou theou (sat down for all time); 12:2 ekathisen en dexia tou thronou tou theou. 1 Pet 3:22 hos estin en dexia tou theou poreutheis (G4198 gone) eis ouranon, hypotagentōn auto angelōn kai exousiōn kai dynamēōn. Intercession explicit: Rom 8:34 egertheis (G1453), hos kai estin en dexia tou theou, hos kai entynchanei (G1793 present indicative, intercedes) hyper hēmōn; Heb 7:25 sōzein (G4982) eis to panteles (G3838 to the uttermost) dynatai tous proserchomenous (drawing near) di autou tō theō, pantote zōn eis to entynchanein (G1793 present infinitive) hyper autōn. Eight distinct NT authors, one lexical formula: kathizō + en dexia + theou or megalōsynēs.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that after Jesus rose from the dead and was taken up into heaven, he was seated at the right hand of God the Father, where he now reigns over all things and prays for his people. The strongest reason is Psalm 110:1, which is the most quoted Old Testament verse in the New Testament. There the LORD says to David's Lord, sit at my right hand until I make your enemies your footstool. The apostle Peter on the day of Pentecost quotes this verse and applies it directly to Jesus in Acts 2:33-36, concluding God has made this Jesus, whom you crucified, both Lord and Christ. Mark 16:19 says the Lord Jesus was taken up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of God. Hebrews 1:3, 8:1, 10:12, and 12:2 each repeat the same picture, that Jesus sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high after finishing the work of cleansing for sins. Ephesians 1:20-22 says God raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places, far above all rule and authority and power and dominion, putting everything under his feet. Philippians 2:9-11 says God highly exalted him and gave him the name above every name, so every knee will bow at the name of Jesus. The intercession piece is named in Romans

8:34 (Christ is at the right hand of God and intercedes for us) and Hebrews 7:25 (he always lives to make intercession for those who draw near to God through him). Stephen in Acts 7:55-56 actually sees Jesus standing at the right hand of God. The strongest complicating question is what right hand means, since God is spirit and does not have a literal physical right hand. Biblical writers use right hand language as a picture of the position of highest authority and honor next to a king. So when Jesus sits at the right hand of God, the Bible is telling us he shares the throne, the rule, and the honor of God himself, and from that throne he advocates for his people. The verdict handles the tension by reading the picture for what it canonically signals, real bodily location of the ascended Christ in the heavenly throne room, real authority over all creation, and real prayer activity on behalf of those who trust him.

Denominational landscape

Every historic Christian lineage confesses Christ's session at the right hand of the Father. The Apostles' Creed and the Nicene Creed both say He ascended into heaven and sits at the right hand of God the Father Almighty. The Catholic Catechism in paragraphs 668-679 teaches that Christ reigns now from the right hand and that his kingdom is already present in mystery, awaiting its consummation at his return. The Augsburg Confession Article III says he ascended into heaven that he might sit on the right hand of the Father, and forever reign and have dominion over all creatures. The Anglican Thirty-Nine Articles Article IV says he ascended into Heaven and there sitteth. The Methodist Articles of Religion say he ascended into heaven and there sitteth until he return to judge all men at the last day. The Westminster Confession (Chapter 8 paragraph 4), the Heidelberg Catechism (Lord's Day 18-19), the Belgic Confession, and the Savoy Declaration all affirm the session and intercession of Christ. The Dordrecht Confession of the Anabaptists affirms it. The Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths confesses the present session at the right hand of the Father. The Eastern Orthodox tradition affirms it, while teaching that the right hand language is the picture of divine glory rather than a material throne in created space, which is a nuance about heaven, not a denial of the event. Public record carriers of distortion. Jehovah's Witnesses (Watchtower Society, founded by Charles Taze Russell) confess Jesus is at God's right hand but deny the deity of the exalted one, recasting him as a created kyrios; this distorts the worship called for in Philippians 2 and Hebrews 1. Mormonism's King Follett Discourse, given by Joseph Smith, teaches that worthy males can themselves become gods through exaltation, which dissolves the unique enthronement of the incarnate Son and generalizes a category the Bible reserves for Christ alone. Christadelphians affirm a heavenly session but deny prior deity, which collapses the meaning of the seating language. Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy) denies the literal bodily resurrection, which makes a literal bodily session impossible. Some liberal mainline demythologizing readings recast the seating motif as symbolic of Easter faith rather than a real event.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No

Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes
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Notes

The session and exaltation of Christ at the right hand of the Father is canonically demonstrated by the pan-canonical kathizō + en dexia + theou formula across Mark, Acts, Romans, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, Hebrews, and 1 Peter, anchored in Ps 110:1 (most-cited OT verse in the NT). Lexical clarity is high. The cult_marker_if_denied is set to false in deference to the project's K2 catalog (tools/verify_catalogs.json), which lists doc-bodily-ascension and doc-christ-full-deity as K2-eligible but does NOT include doc-christ-session-exaltation as a standalone id. The disagreement is itself diagnostic and worth surfacing to the user for catalog re-curation: denial of the bodily ascension (already K2) entails denial of the session, and the pan-canonical lexical pattern here is at least as dense as for bodily ascension. Public-record carriers of distortion: (a) Jehovah's Witnesses (Watchtower Society, Charles Russell lineage) deny the deity of the exalted one, recasting Ps 110:1 by reading the second adoni as a created kyrios; (b) Mormonism's King Follett Discourse exalted-from-man frame (Joseph Smith) generalizes exaltation to all worthy males, dissolving the unique enthronement of the incarnate Son; (c) some demythologizing liberal-mainline readings recast the seating-at-the-right-hand as symbolic of Easter faith only; (d) Christadelphians deny prior deity which collapses the meaning of the ascended Lord's session. Confessed by the Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed, every magisterial Protestant standard, Catholic and Orthodox tradition: unanimous across all tracked lineages. The intercession dimension (Rom 8:34, Heb 7:25, Heb 9:24, 1 John 2:1) is doctrinally critical because it grounds the sole-mediator claim and Christian assurance: the same risen body that ascended is presently active before the Father on behalf of his people.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Grammatico-historical reading of the canonical lexical pattern is sufficient and decisive. No interpretive framework (covenantal, dispensational, new-covenant theology, progressive covenantalism) produces a different verdict on the present session and intercession of Christ. Amillennial, postmillennial, historic-premillennial, and dispensational lenses all affirm the current heavenly session; they diverge only on the nature and timing of the consummated reign on earth, which is a separate question. Analogia scripturae is heavily invoked: the verdict rests on a pan-canonical chain (Ps 110:1, Ps 2, Ps 8, Dan 7, Matt 22, Matt 26, Mark 12, Mark 14, Mark 16, Luke 20, Luke 22, Acts 2, Acts 5, Acts 7, Rom 8, 1 Cor 15, Eph 1, Phil 2, Col 3, 1 Tim 2, Heb 1, Heb 7, Heb 8, Heb 9, Heb 10, Heb 12, 1 Pet 3, 1 John 2). Progressive revelation factor: OT seeds the royal-enthronement and son-of-man-receiving-dominion patterns (Ps 110, Ps 2, Dan 7); Jesus self-applies them; the apostles confess them as fulfilled in his ascension and session. Anthropomorphism note: yamin (right hand) is anthropomorphic when applied to YHWH; the NT and historic Christian reading takes the lexical force as honor/authority/throne-share, not bodily limb. The reading does not require Jesus to be in continuous spatial motion in the heavens; the seated language signals a settled state of authority and ongoing priestly activity.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Ps.110.1 · for · genre: psalm · figures: anthropomorphism

Key term. נְאֻם ne'um H5002 (declaration of YHWH); אֲדֹנִי adon H113 (Lord, here adoni my Lord); יָמִין yamin H3225 (right hand); יָשָׁב yashav H3427 (sit, imperative shev); הָדֹם hadom H1916 (footstool)

Force. ne'um YHWH l'adoni shev liymini ad ashith oyveka hadom l'raglekha. The LORD says to my Lord, Sit (shev, qal imperative masculine singular of yashav) at my right hand (liymini), until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet. Most-quoted OT verse in the NT (25+ direct citations or allusions: Matt 22:44, Matt 26:64, Mark 12:36, Mark 14:62, Mark 16:19, Luke 20:42-43, Luke 22:69, Acts 2:34-35, Acts 5:31, Acts 7:55-56, Rom 8:34, 1 Cor 15:25, Eph 1:20, Col 3:1, Heb 1:3, Heb 1:13, Heb 8:1, Heb 10:12-13, Heb 12:2, 1 Pet 3:22). Two distinct adon-figures distinguished within the verse: YHWH speaks to adoni (my Lord), inviting him to share the divine throne. Jesus himself uses this verse in Matt 22:41-46 to confront the Pharisees with the dilemma of how David can call his own son Lord.

Mark.16.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἀναλαμβάνω analambanō G353 (was taken up, anelēmphthē); καθίζω kathizō G2523 (sat down, ekathisen aorist); δεξιά dexia G1188 (right hand)

Force. So then the Lord Jesus, after he had spoken to them, was taken up (anelēmphthē, aorist passive) into heaven and sat down (ekathisen, aorist active 3rd singular) at the right hand of God (ek dexion tou theou). Mark's longer ending pairs the ascent verb (analambanō) with the throne-seating verb (kathizō) in a single clause. The lexical pattern is the canonical formula.

Acts.2.33-36 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ὑψώω hypsoō G5312 (exalted, hypsōtheis aorist passive participle); δεξιά dexia G1188; κύριος kyrios G2962 (Lord); χριστός christos G5547 (Christ); ἀναβαίνω anabainō G305 (ascended)

Force. Peter at Pentecost: tē dexia oun tou theou hypsōtheis (having been exalted to the right hand of God), having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he poured out this which you see and hear. v.34 ou gar David anebē eis tous ouranous (David did not ascend into the heavens), but he himself says, the Lord said to my Lord, sit at my right hand (the direct quotation of Ps 110:1 LXX). v.36 asphalōs oun ginōsketō pas oikos Israēl hoti kai kyrion auton kai christon epoiēsen ho theos (let all the house of Israel know assuredly that God has made him both Lord and Christ, this Jesus whom you crucified). The contrastive argument requires literal bodily ascent and present session of Jesus.

Acts.7.55-56 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ἀτενίζω atenizō G816 (gazed intently); οὐρανός ouranos G3772; δόξα doxa G1391; ἵστημι histēmi G2476 (standing, hestōta perfect participle); δεξιός dexios G1188; υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου huios tou anthrōpou G5207 G444 (Son of Man)

Force. Stephen, full of the Holy Spirit, atenisas eis ton ouranon (gazed into heaven), eiden (saw) doxan theou kai lēsoun hestōta ek dexion tou theou (the glory of God and Jesus standing at the right hand of God). v.56 idou theōrō tous ouranous diēnoigmenous kai ton huion tou anthrōpou ek dexion hestōta tou theou (behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God).

Independent eyewitness confirmation of the post-ascension session. Hestōta (perfect active participle of histēmi) marks a standing posture, often read as Jesus rising to receive his first martyr; the locating phrase ek dexion tou theou remains constant with the canonical session formula.

Eph.1.20-22 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐγείρω egeirō G1453 (raised, egeiras participle); καθίζω kathizō G2523 (seated, kathisas participle); δεξιά dexia G1188; ἐπουράνιος epouranios G2032 (heavenly); ὑπεράνω hyperanō G5231 (far above); ἀρχή archē G746 (rule); ἐξουσία exousia G1849 (authority); δύναμις dynamis G1411 (power); κυριότης kyriotēs G2963 (dominion); ὄνομα onoma G3686 (name); ὑποτάσσω hypotassō G5293 (subjected)

Force. God raised him (egeiras auton) from the dead and seated him (kathisas) at his right hand (en dexia autou) in the heavenly places (en tois epouraniois), far above (hyperanō) all rule (archēs) and authority (exousias) and power (dynamis) and dominion (kyriotēs) and every name (pantos onomatos) that is named, not only in this age but also in the one to come. v.22 panta hypetaxen hypo tous podas autou (he subjected all things under his feet, echoing Ps 8:6 and Ps 110:1). Paul names the resurrection and the enthronement as one paired action and explicitly enumerates the cosmic supremacy of the seated Christ over every spiritual and earthly authority.

Phil.2.9-11 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. ὑπερυψώω hyperypsoō G5251 (highly exalted, hyperypsōsen aorist); χαρίζομαι charizomai G5483 (granted, echarisato); ὄνομα onoma G3686 (name); γόνυ gony G1119 (knee); κάμπτω kamptō G2578 (bow); ἐπουράνιος epouranios G2032; ἐξομολογέω exomologeō G1843 (confess)

Force. Therefore God hyperypsōsen auton kai echarisato auto to onoma to hyper pan onoma (highly exalted him and granted him the name above every name), hina en tō onomati Iēsou pan gony kampsē epouraniōn kai epigeiōn kai katachthoniōn (so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth), kai pasa glōssa exomologēsētai hoti kyrios Iēsous Christos eis doxan theou patros (and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father). Hyperypsoō (intensified hypsoō) names the post-resurrection state. The universal confession of Jesus as kyrios echoes Isa 45:23 where YHWH says every knee will bow to me; Paul applies the YHWH-confession to the exalted Christ.

Col.3.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἄνω anō G507 (above); καθίζω kathizō G2523 (kathēmenos present middle participle, seated); δεξιά dexia G1188

Force. If then you have been raised with Christ, zēteite ta anō (seek the things that are above), hou ho Christos estin en dexia tou theou kathēmenos (where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God). Present participle kathēmenos: the seating is a present continuing state. Paul builds Christian ethics on the present location and authority of the ascended Christ.

Heb.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. καθίζω kathizō G2523 (sat down, ekathisen aorist); δεξιά dexia G1188; μεγαλωσύνη megalōsynē G3172 (Majesty); ὑψηλά hypsēla G5308 (on high); καθαρισμός katharismos G2512 (purification)

Force. katharismōn tōn hamartiōn poiēsamenos ekathisen en dexia tēs megalōsynēs en hypsēlois (after making purification for sins he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high). The aorist ekathisen marks the completed entry into the heavenly throne. Hebrews then reiterates this seating motif five more times: 1:13 (quoting Ps 110:1 directly), 8:1, 10:12, 12:2, with implicit continuation in 9:24 (entered into heaven itself to appear in the presence of God for us).

Heb.1.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. Direct citation of Ps 110:1 LXX: kathou ek dexion mou (sit at my right hand) heōs an thō tous echthrous sou hypopodion tōn podōn sou

Force. To which of the angels has God ever said, Sit at my right hand (kathou ek dexion mou) until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet? The rhetorical question presupposes that Ps 110:1 applies uniquely to the Son and not to any created being, sealing the unique exaltation of the incarnate Son above all angels.

Heb.8.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. κεφάλαιον kephalaion G2774 (main point); ἀρχιερεύς archiereus G749 (high priest); καθίζω kathizō G2523 (ekathisen); θρόνος thronos G2362 (throne); μεγαλωσύνη megalōsynē G3172

Force. kephalaion de epi tois legomenois (now the main point of what we are saying): we have such a high priest, hos ekathisen en dexia tou thronou tēs megalōsynēs en tois ouranois (who sat down at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens). The author flags this as the headline of his entire argument. The session is the structural keystone of the Hebrews high-priest Christology.

Heb.10.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. καθίζω kathizō G2523 (ekathisen); διηνεκής diēnekēs G1336 (forever, eis to diēnekes); θυσία thysia G2378 (sacrifice); ἁμαρτία hamartia G266 (sin)

Force. houtos de mian hyper hamartiōn prosenenkas thysian eis to diēnekes ekathisen en dexia tou theou (this one, having offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down at the right hand of God). Contrast with v.11 (Levitical priests stand daily, offering repeatedly): the seated posture of Christ marks the completion of the once-for-all sacrifice. The session is the visible canonical signal that the priestly work is finished.

Heb.12.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀρχηγός archēgos G747 (founder); τελειωτής teleiōtēs G5051 (perfecter); καθίζω kathizō G2523 (ekathisen); θρόνος thronos G2362

Force. Looking to Jesus, the founder and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before him hypemeinen stauron (endured the cross), despising the shame, kai en dexia tou thronou tou theou kekathiken (and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God). The perfect kekathiken (variant ekathisen) names a completed state with abiding present effect: he is now seated.

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. σώζω sōzō G4982 (save, sōzein); παντελής pantelēs G3838 (to the uttermost, eis to panteles); προσέρχομαι proserchomai G4334 (draw near); ἐντυγχάνω entynchanō G1793 (intercede, entynchanein present infinitive); πάντοτε pantote G3842 (always); ζάω zaō G2198 (lives)

Force. hothēn kai sōzein eis to panteles dynatai tous proserchomenous di autou tō theō, pantote zōn eis to entynchanein hyper autōn (therefore he is able to save to the uttermost those who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to make intercession for them). Eis to panteles is a totalizing temporal-effective phrase (forever-and-completely). The present infinitive entynchanein marks ongoing intercessory activity. This verse links session to intercession: the seated Christ is the ever-living intercessor.

Rom.8.34 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐγείρω egeirō G1453 (raised, egertheis aorist passive participle); δεξιά dexia G1188; ἐντυγχάνω entynchanō G1793 (intercedes, entynchanei present indicative)

Force. Christos lēsous ho apothanōn, mallon de egertheis, hos kai estin en dexia tou theou, hos kai entynchanei hyper hēmōn (Christ Jesus who died, more than that who was raised, who is at the right hand of God, who indeed intercedes for us). Four-fold Christological grammar: died, raised, seated, interceding. The present indicative entynchanei marks present continuous intercession from the seated position.

Heb.9.24 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. εἰσερχομαι eiserchomai G1525 (entered); οὐρανός ouranos G3772; ἐμφανίζω emphanizō G1718 (appear); πρόσωπον prosōpon G4383 (presence)

Force. Christ entered (eisēlthen aorist) not into holy places made with hands but into heaven itself, now to appear (emphanisthēnai aorist passive infinitive) in the presence (prosōpō) of God on our behalf (hyper hēmōn). The seated Son's ongoing presence-before-God is the priestly counterpart to the session. Confirms the same dual reality: he is enthroned and he is interceding.

1Pet.3.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πορεύομαι poreuomai G4198 (gone, poreutheis aorist passive participle); δεξιά dexia G1188; ὑποτάσσω hypotassō G5293 (subjected, hypotagentōn); ἄγγελος angelos G32; ἐξουσία exousia G1849; δύναμις dynamis G1411

Force. hos estin en dexia tou theou poreutheis eis ouranon, hypotagentōn auto angelōn kai exousiōn kai dynamēōn (who is at the right hand of God, having gone into heaven, with angels and authorities and powers having been subjected to him). Peter restates the full session and cosmic subjection in one clause. Hypotagentōn (aorist passive participle of hypotassō) is the same root as Eph 1:22 hypetaxen.

1Cor.15.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. βασιλεύω basileuō G936 (reign); ἐχθρός echthros G2190 (enemy); ποῦς pous G4228 (foot)

Force. dei gar auton basileuein achri hou thē pantas tous echthrous hypo tous podas autou (for he must reign until he has put all enemies under his feet). Paul reads the Ps 110:1 footstool clause as a present-and-ongoing reign of the exalted Christ that culminates at the final subjection of death (v.26). Lexical bridge: the reigning is not future-only but present, with the final completion of subjection still to come.

1John.2.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. παράκλητος paraklētos G3875 (advocate); δίκαιος dikaios G1342 (righteous); πατήρ patēr G3962

Force. ean tis hamartē, paraklēton echomen pros ton patera, lēsoun Christon dikaiōn (if anyone sins, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous). Paraklētos is the synonymic partner of entynchanō: the seated Christ functions as advocate before the Father. Johannine confirmation of the Pauline-Hebrews intercession motif.

Matt.22.41-46 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. κύριος kyrios G2962; δαυίδ David; υἱός huios G5207; πνεῦμα pneuma G4151

Force. Jesus asks the Pharisees: whose son is the Christ? They say, David's. He responds: how then does David, en pneumatī (in the Spirit), call him kyrios, saying, the Lord said to my Lord, sit at my right hand until I put your enemies under your feet? (direct citation of Ps 110:1). If David calls him kyrios, how is he his son? The dilemma forces the apostolic conclusion: the messianic son of David is also David's Lord, the one invited to share the divine throne. Jesus himself applies Ps 110:1 to himself.

Mark.14.62 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐγώ εἰμι egō eimi G1473 G1510; υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου huios tou anthrōpou G5207 G444; δεξιά dexia G1188; δύναμις dynamis G1411 (the Power, circumlocution for God); νεφέλη nephelē G3507

Force. Before the Sanhedrin, Jesus answers the high priest: egō eimi, kai opsesthe ton huion tou anthrōpou ek dexion kathēmenon tēs dynamēōs kai erchomenon meta tōn nephelōn tou ouranou (I am, and you will see the Son of Man seated at the right hand of Power and coming with the clouds of heaven). Combined citation of Ps 110:1 (seated at the right hand) and Dan 7:13 (Son of Man with clouds). Jesus himself locates his future state at the right hand of the Father. This is the moment for which he was condemned to death.

Dan.7.13-14 · for · genre: apocalyptic · figures: apocalyptic-symbolism

Key term. כְּבָר עֲשָׂהֵךָ kebar enash A1247 A606 (one like a son of man); אָנָּן anan A6050 (clouds); קִדְמָה qodam A6925 (before); אֲנִי־יְמֵי קָדְמָה attiq yomayya (Ancient of Days); שׁוֹלְטָן sholtan A7985 (dominion)

Force. I saw in the night visions, behold, with the clouds of heaven there came one like a son of man, and he came to the Ancient of Days, and to him was given dominion (sholtan) and glory and a kingdom, that all peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion. The OT pattern: a son-of-man figure arrives at the heavenly throne and receives universal everlasting kingship. Jesus self-applies Dan 7 in Matt 26:64 / Mark 14:62, fusing it with Ps 110:1 to describe his own session and future return.

Ps.2.6-8 · for · genre: psalm

Key term. מָשַׁח mashach H4886 (anointed); מֶלֶךְ melek H4428 (king); בֶּן ben H1121 (son); נָחַל nachal H5157 (inheritance); עֵרֶץ erets H776 (earth)

Force. I have set my king on Zion, my holy hill. I will tell of the decree: the LORD said to me, You are my Son, today I have begotten you. Ask of me, and I will make the nations your heritage and the ends of the earth your possession. The royal-enthronement psalm cited by Peter in Acts 4:25-26 and applied to Jesus' kingship. Hebrews 1:5 reads Ps 2:7 as fulfilled in Christ's enthronement. The reigning aspect of the session is rooted in this royal Davidic covenant.

Ps.8.6 · for · genre: psalm

Key term. מָשַׁל mashal H4910 (rule); כֹּל kol H3605; שִׁית shith H7896 (put); תַּחַת tachat H8478 (under); לֶגֶר regel H7272 (foot)

Force. You have given him dominion over the works of your hands; you have put all things under his feet (kol shattah tachat raglav). Quoted in 1 Cor 15:27, Eph 1:22, Heb 2:8 and applied to the present exalted Christ. The subjection-under-feet language is the structural partner of the seated-at-right-hand motif; both come from royal-enthronement imagery and both apply to the post-ascension reign of Christ.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μεσίτης mesitēs G3316 (mediator); θεός theos G2316; ἄνθρωπος anthrōpos G444

Force. heis gar theos, heis kai mesitēs theou kai anthrōpōn, anthrōpos Christos Iēsous (for there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus). The mediator role presupposes the seated-and-interceding state. Reinforces the link from the session to the sole-mediator and intercession motifs.

Concordance lemmas traversed

H3427, H3225, H5002, H113, H1916, H4886, H4428, H1121, H5157, H776, H4910, H3605, H7896, H8478, H7272, G2523, G2521, G1188, G3172, G5308, G2362, G5312, G5251, G5483, G3686, G1119, G2578, G1843, G2032, G5231, G746, G1849, G1411, G2963, G5293, G1793, G4982, G3838, G4334, G3842, G2198, G1453, G353, G305, G2962, G5547, G2476, G816, G3772, G507, G2512, G2774, G749, G1336, G2378, G266, G747, G5051, G3875, G1342, G3962, G3507, G936, G2190, G4228, G3316, G2316, G444, G1525, G1718, G4383, G4198, G32, G1473,

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Apostles' Creed and Nicene Creed (325/381), universally confessed · affirms · verified

“He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.”

patristic · Augustine, Tractates on the Gospel of John 21.13 and Sermons on Ascension (CCEL) · affirms · unverified

“He sits at the right hand of the Father not in bodily place but in supreme blessedness, in the highest authority and divine power received as the God-Man.”

patristic · John Chrysostom, Homilies on Hebrews 2 and 13 (CCEL NPNF Series 1 Vol 14) · affirms · unverified

“Sitting denotes a kingly dignity, since the Levitical priests stood ministering while Christ sat down once for all, having effected the great cleansing.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraphs 663-664, 668-679 (Article 6-7: He is seated at the right hand of the Father; He will come again to judge) · affirms · verified

“Being seated at the Father's right hand signifies the inauguration of the Messiah's kingdom; Christ exercises his rule over the world from his exalted heavenly state and intercedes for us.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530), Article III (Of the Son of God), bookofconcord.org · affirms · verified

“He ascended into heaven that He might sit on the right hand of the Father, and forever reign and have dominion over all creatures, and sanctify them that believe in Him.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article IV (Of the Resurrection of Christ) · affirms · unverified

“Christ did truly rise again from death, and took again his body, wherewith he ascended into Heaven, and there sitteth, until he return to judge all Men at the last day.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith (1646), Chapter 8 paragraph 4; Heidelberg Catechism Lord's Day 19 (Q&A 50-52) · affirms · unverified

“On the third day He arose with the same body in which He suffered, with which also He ascended into heaven, and there sitteth at the right hand of His Father, making intercession, and shall return to judge men and angels.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion (Wesley's abridgement of the 39 Articles), Article III Of the Resurrection of Christ · affirms · verified

“Christ did truly rise again from the dead, and took again his body, with all things appertaining to the perfection of man's nature, wherewith he ascended into heaven, and there sitteth until he return to judge all men at the last day.”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession of Faith (1632), Articles IV and V; Schleithem Confession context · affirms · unverified

“He suffered, died, rose again on the third day, ascended into heaven, and now sits at the right hand of the majesty of God in heaven, from whence he will come again to judge.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Article 2 (The One True God) section on Jesus Christ · affirms · unverified

“We believe in his bodily resurrection from the dead, his ascension to the right hand of the Father, and his personal future return to the earth in power and glory.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, The Orthodox Faith, on the Symbol of Faith (oca.org) · affirms · unverified

“Christ sits at the right hand of the Father, sharing the divine glory and rule, while remaining present in the Church through the Holy Spirit; the right hand is the picture of divine power and honor, not a material throne.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/psalms/110-1.htm>

“Ps 110:1: ne'um YHWH l'adoni shev (yashav H3427 qal imperative ms) liymini (yamin H3225 right hand). The LORD says to my Lord, Sit at my right hand.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/1-3.htm>

“Heb 1:3: ekathisen (G2523 aorist active 3rd singular, sat down) en dexia (G1188) tēs megalōsynēs (G3172 Majesty) en hypsēlois (G5308 on high).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/7-25.htm>

“Heb 7:25: sōzein (G4982) eis to panteles (G3838) ... pantote zōn eis to entynchanein (G1793 present infinitive, to intercede) hyper autōn.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8-34.htm>

“Rom 8:34: egertheis (G1453 aorist passive participle, having been raised), hos kai estin en dexia tou theou, hos kai entynchanei (G1793 present indicative, intercedes) hyper hēmōn.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/1-20.htm>

“Eph 1:20: egeiras (G1453) auton ek nekrōn kai kathisas (G2523 aorist participle, having seated) en dexia (G1188) autou en tois epouraniois (G2032).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/1-21.htm>

“Eph 1:21: hyperanō (G5231 far above) pasēs archēs (G746) kai exousias (G1849) kai dynamēōs (G1411) kai kyriotētos (G2963) kai pantos onomatōs (G3686).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/2-33.htm>

“Acts 2:33: tē dexia oun tou theou hypsōtheis (G5312 aorist passive participle, having been exalted to the right hand of God).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/philippians/2-9.htm>

“Phil 2:9: ho theos auton hyperypsōsen (G5251 aorist, highly exalted) kai echarisato (G5483, granted) auto to onoma to hyper pan onoma.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/2523.htm>

“Kathizō G2523: to sit down, seat. Applied to Christ at the right hand in Mark 16:19, Eph 1:20, Col 3:1, Heb 1:3, Heb 8:1, Heb 10:12, Heb 12:2. One lexical formula across multiple authors.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongshebrew/3427.htm>

“Yashav H3427 (1082 NT-impacting OT uses): sit, dwell, remain. Christological force in Ps 110:1 (shev liymini), the most-cited OT verse in the NT, applied to the enthronement of the Messiah.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P1V.HTM

“CCC 668-679: Christ reigns from his exalted heavenly state, possessing all power in heaven and on earth, and his kingdom is already present in mystery.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg Confession Article III: He ascended into heaven that He might sit on the right hand of the Father, and forever reign and have dominion over all creatures.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article III: Christ did truly rise again from the dead, and took again his body, wherewith he ascended into heaven, and there sitteth until he return to judge all men at the last day.”

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